If any of you have known me my entire life, you'd know two things about me. One, I've always had an affinity for writing and two, I've always felt the need to stand up for the oppressed. While often I keep my thoughts private and mainly keep my opinions and conversations away from strangers, this case surrounding the Cornell 7 hits a little closer as my niece approaches her first birthday this month.

My niece is the first of the next generation of my family. When I see her, her eyes reflect pure hope. Right now, she can barely walk without the assistance of a hand from her parents and this is what scares me the most. Because once she walks, she is one step further from being away from the protection and love from her family.

Everyone here has a woman in their family and most likely, these women mean everything to us, at least for me they do. While the particularities of this case is disgusting, it highlights a broader issue surrounding men. As a member in a leadership position of a fraternity, I've heard people say that they feel that fraternities across the nation feel "attacked." And if you are reading this and you feel that I am "doing too much" or feel "attacked" I encourage you to look at yourself in the mirror and ask yourself why that is.

People aren't attacking fraternities, they are speaking up to a system. A system that allows for the evil of men to live. A system that shames women for speaking up. A system that hides the evil, in an effort to hide the fact that the system is evil in itself.

While it is easy to post and pray and wish every victim gets their justice, it is likely that this just becomes a trend. This is unless we change the system. To all the men reading this, be what it means to be a man. It's not being tough or cool or whatever this world perceives it to be. It is simply being someone who wants the safety of their niece or loved one, to feel that same safety of being held up by their loved ones.